

Lab 2: Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

Deliverable Report

Project	software_eng (Key: SE)
Tool Used	Jira (Company-managed Scrum project)
Sprints Completed	2 (SE Sprint 1, SE Sprint 3)
Epics Created	3 — Budget Visibility, Timesheet Approval Workflow, Time Entry & Validation

1. Epics & Backlog Structure

The backlog was organized into three Epics, each grouping related user stories: **Budget Visibility**, **Timesheet Approval Workflow**, and **Time Entry & Validation**. The screenshot below shows the Epic panel in the Jira Backlog view, confirming that every user story in the project is mapped to a parent Epic.

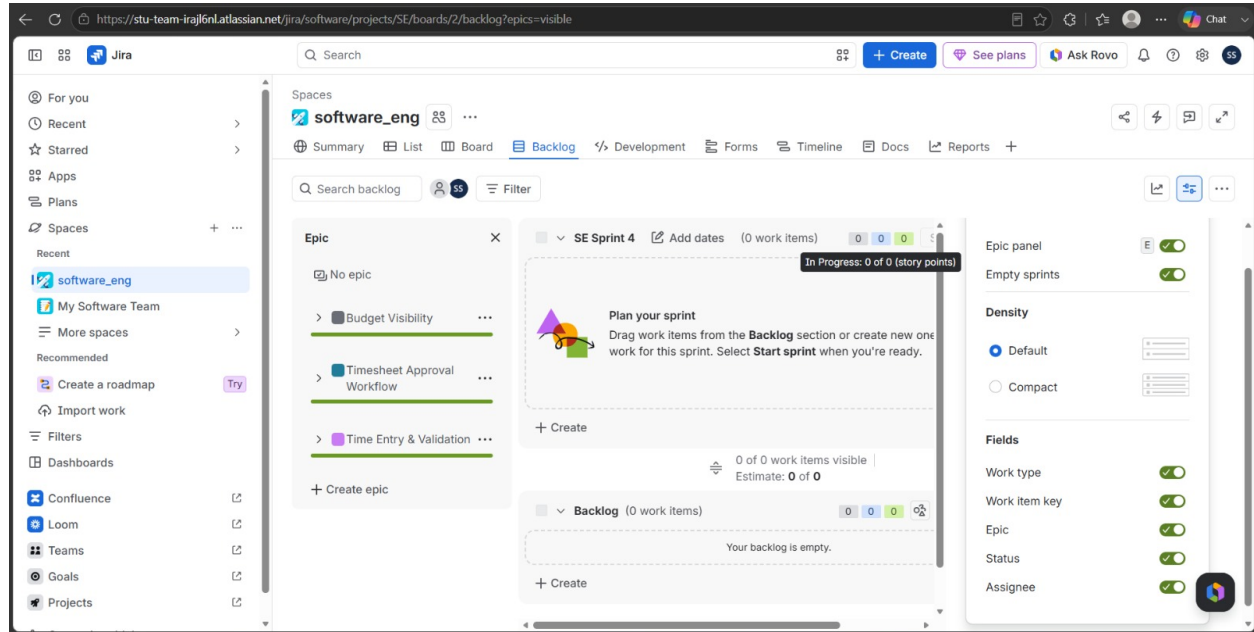


Figure 1: Epic panel showing all Epics in the software_eng backlog.

2. Sprint Execution & Burndown Charts

Sprint 1

SE Sprint 1 was run with 18 story points across 5 user stories (SE-6 through SE-10), covering hours logging, ticket linking, entry validation, timesheet submission, and approval/rejection. All 5 items were moved to Done and the sprint was completed successfully.

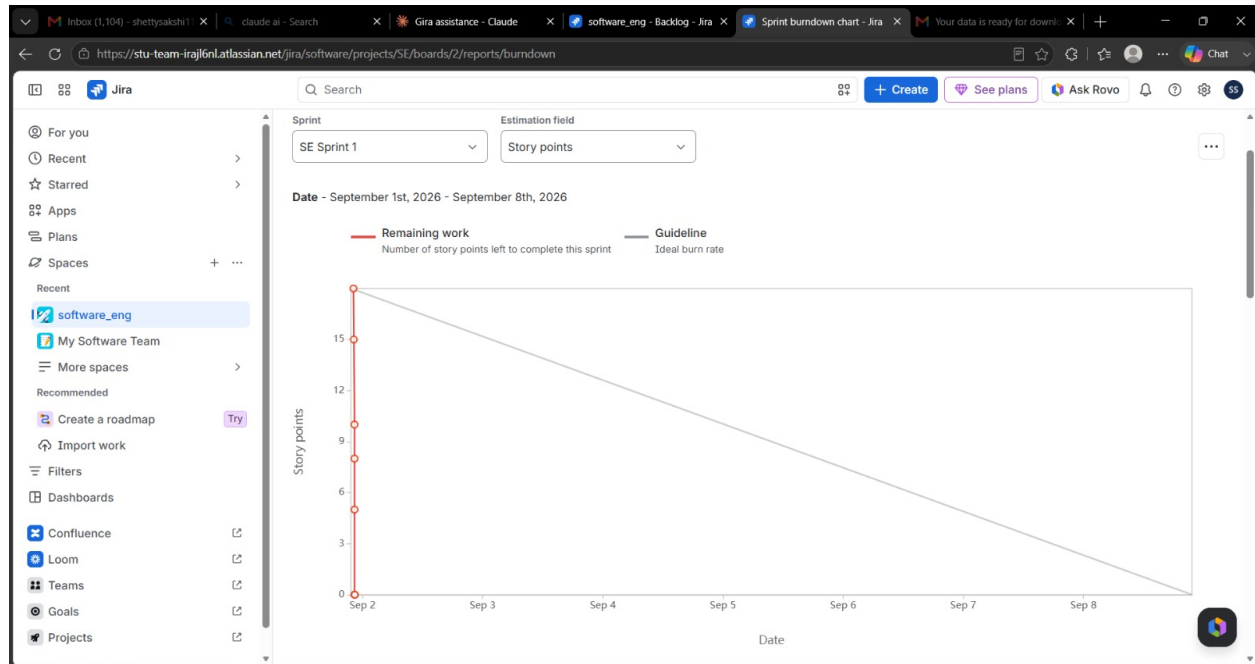


Figure 2: Burndown Chart — SE Sprint 1 (18 story points, Sep 1–8, 2026).

Sprint 2 (SE Sprint 3)

The second completed sprint carried 8 story points, made up of the remaining backlog items (comment-on-rejection and budget burn-rate visibility). This sprint was also driven to full completion, with all planned work marked Done.

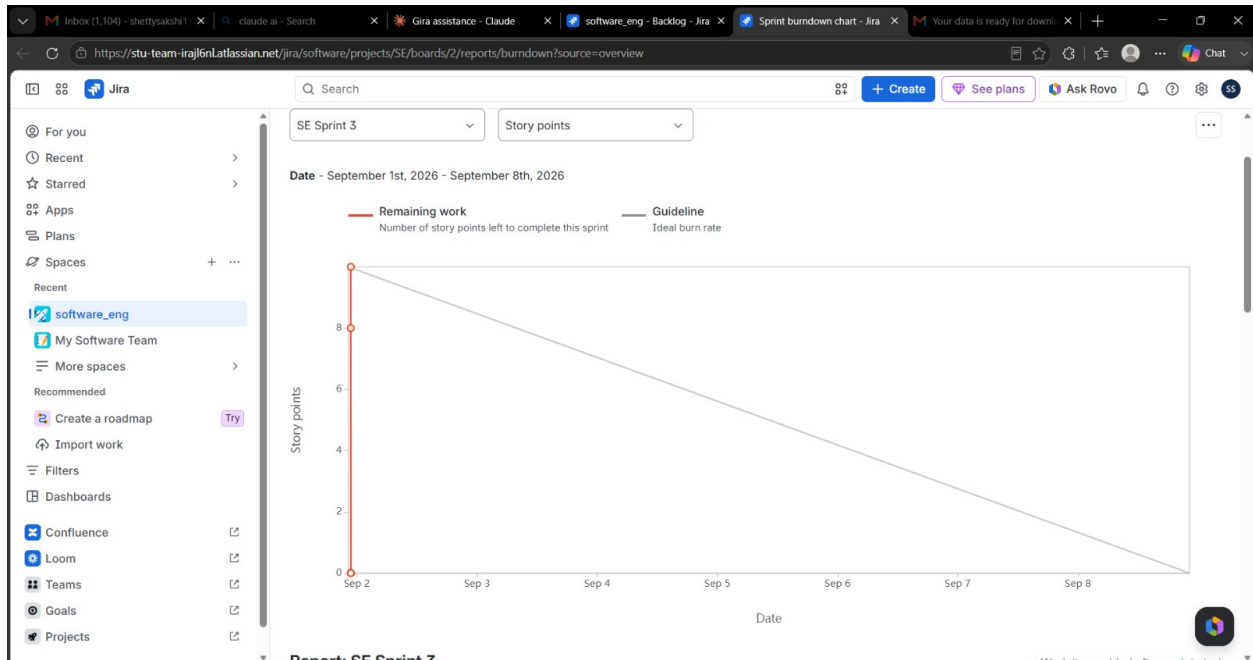


Figure 3: Burndown Chart — SE Sprint 3 (8 story points, Sep 1–8, 2026).

3. Reflection Questions

Q1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Not fully, because both sprints were simulated rather than executed in real time. Story points were assigned using the Fibonacci scale based on perceived complexity (e.g., 2 points for a simple validation rule, 8 points for the more complex budget burn-rate feature), but since every item was moved straight to Done without spending real time in progress, the burndown charts cannot confirm whether those estimates matched the actual effort required. In a live sprint, tracking would need to happen over the full week to validate the estimates.

Q2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Largely yes. Higher-impact items — such as blocking over-24-hour entries and submitting/approving timesheets — were flagged as High priority and pulled into Sprint 1 first, while lower-urgency items like adding a rejection comment and the budget burn-rate view were left for the following sprint. This reflects a reasonable value-based ordering, though the burn-rate story (8 points) is noticeably larger than the rest and might have benefited from being broken into smaller stories.

Q3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

Both sprints completed all planned scope, so in terms of scope delivery, the simulation matched the plan. However, the pacing did not reflect a realistic sprint: instead of a gradual decline in remaining work across the week (as shown by the grey Guideline in both burndown charts), the red Remaining Work line dropped from full scope to zero almost immediately on the first day. This happened because tasks were moved directly from To Do to Done for the purpose of the simulation, rather than being progressed incrementally over several days as would happen in an actual sprint.

Q4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

Taken at face value, a burndown chart that drops instantly to zero would normally be a warning sign in a real team — it usually indicates the sprint was under-scoped, or that work was marked complete without being properly verified. Since this was a simulated sprint rather than a real one, the chart's shape says more about the simulation method than actual team capacity. The exercise highlighted why burndown charts are useful in practice: a similarly shaped chart on a real project would prompt a team to investigate whether they are under-committing during sprint planning, rather than take early completion at face value.